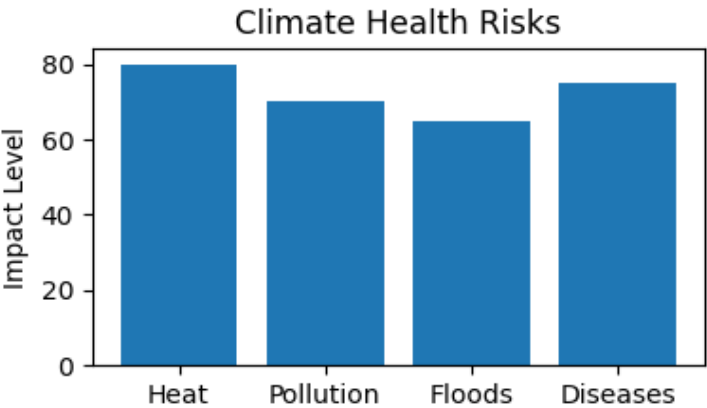


climate change and global health challenges in 2026

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Climate change remains one of the greatest global public health threats in 2026. International conferences on climate and health emphasized the increasing impact of extreme heat, air pollution, floods, droughts, and infectious diseases on vulnerable populations.¹ Experts highlighted that rising temperatures contribute to respiratory illnesses, cardiovascular diseases, food insecurity, and mental health disorders. African countries are particularly affected because of limited healthcare resources and growing environmental pressures.² Participants recommended strengthening healthcare systems through improved emergency preparedness, climate-resilient infrastructure, scientific research, and early disease surveillance. Greater international cooperation and financial support were also encouraged to assist developing nations in adapting to climate-related health risks.³ The conference concluded that climate action is essential not only for environmental protection but also for safeguarding human health and future generations.

References

- 1. World Health Organization, 2025, 12, 45–52.
- 2. Climate and Health Alliance, 2025, 8, 20–28.
- 3. United Nations Climate Reports, 2026, 15, 60–66.